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Blog For A Cause

Blogs can go much beyond being online diaries. Here's a blogging contest that aims to promote cancer awareness

Renuka Rane

A wonderful example of how useful the Internet can be, a blog has it all—from being an online confessional diary to becoming a platform to rave and rant, and critique and praise any and every subject under the sun. And if bloggers were to utilise some of their free Web hosting space to promote a worthy cause, it just could help someone in need.

Espousing a social cause on a blog allows a blogger to do just that: a blogging contest in aid of cancer awareness has been launched in Chennai. To participate, bloggers need to put up content on their blogs

supporting the 'Can Conquer Cancer' initiative. You can find the contest at <http://connexion-online.biz/conxw/ican/>.

What It's About

The contest was started by Muralikrishnan R, CEO of Quicksilver, a placement agency. The idea of a blog contest to promote awareness came to him after the tsunami of 2004. He says about it, "The blogging circuit came alive like never before to mobilise resources for the tsunami-hit regions and get help. I realised that blogs can make a real difference in spreading awareness and help dispel myths—in fact, the use of a blog can achieve much more than an e-mail or Web site based campaign."

An avid blogger himself, Muralikrishnan also manages the promotional work of Connex-

ions, a popular departmental store in Chennai. Connexions, which is a major sponsor of the blogging contest, recently joined hands with the Rotary Club of Chennai Metro to promote the "Can Conquer Cancer" programme.

Murali further adds, "We believe that there's an upside to any challenge, so when it comes to spreading awareness about cancer, we wanted to get everyone involved. Essentially, we want to spread the message that cancer can be conquered, and get everybody to do their bit."

"Our efforts aim at infusing a positive attitude among bloggers and readers and providing hope to those battling the disease".

Can Conquer Cancer

The contest, which began on 28 November 2005, is still on. As the

